TRS/BJP: CARTEL COMBAT PG 11

KERALA: TROUBLED TRUCE AT VIZHINJAM PORT PG 14

UPFRONT

BENGAL BJP: CALLING MITHUN PG 12

RANSOMWARE: THE OTHER KIND OF VIRUS PG 16



IN THE RING Ashok Gehlot with Sachin Pilot after their meeting in Jaipur on November 29

ROHIT JAIN PARAS

RAJASTHAN

A FRAGILE PEACE

By Rohit Parihar

Ridden with internal dissent, with sharp words exchanged between grandees at regular intervals and enough drama to fill the politics pages of national dailies for days on end, the Rajasthan Congress is among the most keenly watched political units in India. It's an open question if there are more fireworks in store for later this month after Rahul Gandhi's Bharat Jodo Yatra completes its journey through the state, and coincidentally the party too celebrates its fourth year in power. To perhaps obviate such a possibility, AICC president Mallikarjun Kharge on December 5 appointed Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa, ex-deputy chief minister of Punjab, as in-charge of Rajasthan, replacing Ajay Maken, who had offered to quit last month. "The situation in Rajasthan is like that in Punjab; we lost there due to infighting," Randhawa told mediapersons after assuming charge on December 6.

Maken had wanted the high command to act against three Rajasthan Congress leaders he had accused of instigating party MLAs to not attend the legislative party meeting on September 25 at Jaipur. That meet had a tricky agenda: to discuss chief minister Ashok Gehlot's replacement as he